

1770 ▶ 1790

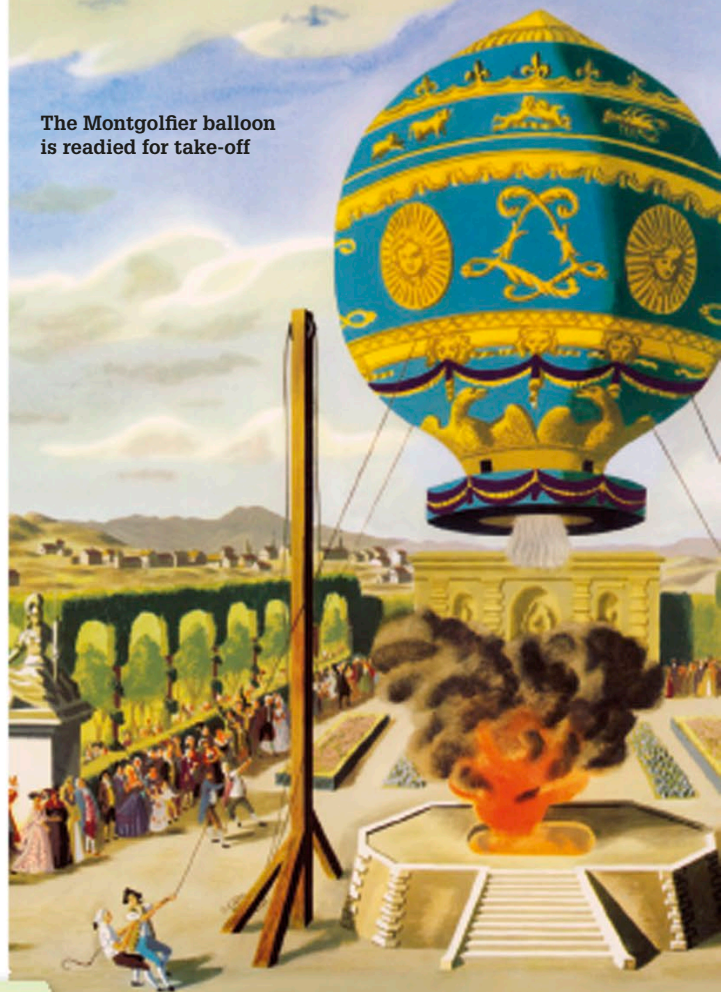
1771

Spinning tales

The water frame, a machine for spinning yarn from cotton fiber, was invented by English inventor Richard Arkwright. Powered by a water wheel, his machine could spin 128 threads at a time—the beginning of mass production.



The Montgolfier balloon is readied for take-off



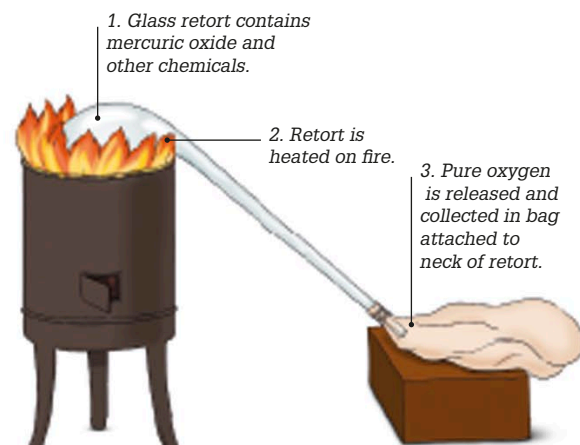
1770

1775

1772

Discovery of oxygen

Swedish chemist Carl Scheele produced a gas, which he called "fire air," when he heated various chemical compounds together. We now know the gas as oxygen. English scientist Joseph Priestley independently discovered the same gas in 1774. He showed that candles do not burn without oxygen.

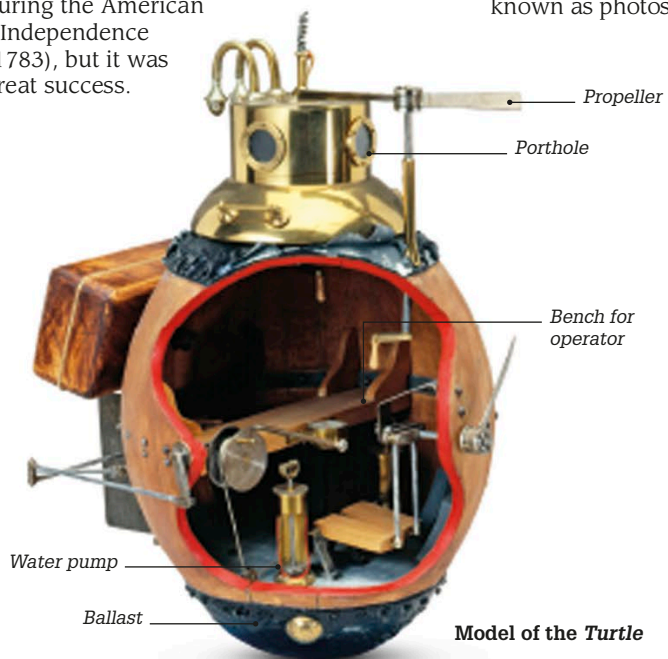


Scheele's apparatus for extracting oxygen

1776

Sub attack!

In North America, inventor David Bushnell designed a submarine called the *Turtle*. He planned to use it to attach bombs to the hulls of British ships during the American War of Independence (1776–1783), but it was not a great success.



Model of the *Turtle*

1778

How plants make food

Dutch biologist Jan Ingenhousz discovered that plants need sunlight to make food and that they give off oxygen as a waste product. This process is now known as photosynthesis.